GENDER, WORK & ORGANIZATION

Special Issue Call for Papers

Feminist AI: Feminist perspectives on Artificial Intelligence (AI) in the workplace

Guest Editors

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The digitalization of work, accelerated by the COVID-19 pandemic, has created an urgent need to understand and foster inclusion in increasingly virtual and hybrid work environments (Magrizos et al., 2023), fundamentally transforming organizational approaches and necessitating new conceptualizations of workplace inclusion (Georgiadou et al., 2024). As artificial intelligence (AI) technologies play an expanding role in shaping these workplaces – impacting everything from recruitment and performance evaluation to communication and collaboration - their rapid development and implementation is profoundly reshaping work and organizations. At the same time AI technologies are designed and developed within the organizational context where work is largely informed by market logics. With AI systems becoming prevalent across industries and job functions, it is essential to examine their impacts at workplaces and also work around the development of AI through a feminist lens (Wajcman and Young, 2023).

This special issue seeks to advance the concept of Feminist AI - the intersection of feminist theory, ontology, epistemology, and methodology with research on AI in workplace and organization studies. Feminist AI is rooted in the 1980's Feminist Science and Technology scholarship that drew attention to the exclusion of women from the knowledge production and the implications of said exclusion (Toupin, 2024). Since then, the concept of Feminist AI has developed further and in parallel with e.g., Transfeminist AI and Posthuman AI (Toupin, 2024), as well as Indigenous AI (Arista et al., 2021), data feminism (D'Ignazio and Klein, 2020), Technofeminism (Wajcman, 2006), Cyborg feminism (Haraway, 2006), among others. Here, we use Feminist AI as an umbrella term that follows on from the tradition of the above-mentioned movements and as a continuation of the Feminist Science and Technology Studies. We frame Feminist AI as such for three reasons. First, we wish to position diverse Feminist AI approaches as theoretical lens that can help us critically analyse and challenge the intersectional gendered and queer implications of AI in the workplace, and to propose feminist epistemologies and methodologies to AI development and use in contemporary organizations. Second, we wish to draw attention to the fact that, similarly to the more mundane technologies, AI, too, can and is already influencing gender and gender relations, and thus it is crucial to apply a feminist lens to shape the technology's trajectory within the workplace (Cockburn, 1997). Third, by framing AI in workplaces through feminist lens we hope that authors would be able to understand planned and unplanned implications of AI based tool (such as Generative AI) adoption as social experiences of employees and employers which in turn can provide opportunity to reflect on both economic and cultural implications of rapid AI adoption in organizations.

Feminist AI in the context of organization studies is intended to explore how AI technologies influence gender dynamics in various contexts, including the workplace; how AI technologies are influenced by intersectional gender dynamics in various organizations; and how feminist principles can inform AI systems' design, implementation, use and governance to promote gender equality and challenge existing biases. In other words, Feminist AI looks at challenging hegemonic forms of AI development and deployment, proposing alternative models, designs, and policies, and reframing AI through varied lenses such as indigenous AI, social justice lens, human rights-based AI model optimization, etc. (Toupin, 2024).

As Wellner and Rothman (2020) argue, AI has the potential to both reinforce and disrupt traditional gender roles and power structures in organizations. However, unlike previous technologies that were often adopted with measured caution or resistance, the rapid and largely unquestioned uptake of AI—driven by significant hype—heightens the risk of embedding systemic biases. Without intentional feminist interventions, AI systems risk perpetuating and amplifying existing gender biases and inequalities (Leavy, 2018). A Feminist AI approach is critical for ensuring that the design and implementation of these technologies promotes rather than hinders gender equality and inclusion. At the same time, it provides an opportunity to explore the adoption and development of AI as rituals and rites of passage (Turner, 1969). These can be further investigated to make sense of AI driven workplace dynamics and temporalities, velocity and veracity of AI adoption evident in evolving boundaries of workplaces (for instance algorithms setting expectations for teleworkers and uber drivers).

Moreover, as Kumar and Choudhury (2022) highlight, the impacts of AI on gender dynamics can vary significantly across different cultural and socioeconomic contexts, shaped by the inherently gendered and racialized nature of predictive technologies. Indeed, within the AI sector, there are clear disparities across gender and racial lines, where minorities are not only severely underrepresented, but their underrepresentation further leads into what D'Ignazio and Klein (2020) call the privilege hazard, i.e., the inability to identify harms and biases in AI systems. This privilege hazard thus ultimately results in reproducing, reinforcing and perpetuating harms and biases. Here, we wish to echo Toupin's cautionary words that Feminist AI will not be and cannot be the panacea because by its very nature is part of the extractivist capitalistic system that has an interest in perpetuating discrimination (Toupin, 2024). Yet, we also argue that a truly inclusive approach to Feminist AI can and must account for these variations, recognizing how AI may reproduce diverse intersectional structures, namely systems of inequality that arise from overlapping identities, such as gender, ethnicity, and socioeconomic status

(Browne et al., 2023), incorporating diverse theoretical perspectives and contributions, particularly from the Global South (Vannini et al., 2024).

Objectives of the Special Issue

This special issue titled *Feminist AI: Feminist Perspectives on Artificial Intelligence (AI) in the Workplace*, seeks to advance the concept of Feminist AI and its applications in work and organizational settings by:

- Developing feminist theoretical approaches to understanding and shaping AI in the workplace
- Examining how AI systems are impacting gendered experiences, identities, and power dynamics at work
- Exploring the potential of AI to both reinforce and disrupt gender inequalities across different contexts
- Proposing feminist interventions and alternatives for more equitable AI design and implementation

This Special Issue invites original research articles, theoretical contributions, and empirical studies that engage with the following themes:

- How can feminist theory inform the development and implementation of AI in workplace settings?
- What does a feminist approach to AI look like in practice?
- How are AI technologies shaping gender performance and identity at work?
- How are AI technologies shaped by gender relations and identity at the site of their production?
- In what ways does AI challenge or reinforce existing gender inequalities in organizations?
- How do the effects of AI on gender vary across national, cultural, and industry contexts?
- What feminist design principles or governance frameworks could promote more equitable AI systems?
- How can FeminAI address intersectional concerns, considering gender alongside race and other dimensions of identity?
- How are experiences of inclusion and exclusion in digital workplaces shaped by AI technologies?

- What new forms of gender bias and discrimination are emerging in AI-driven work processes?
- How can organizations foster digital inclusion while leveraging AI technologies?

We are particularly interested in submissions that:

- Develop novel theoretical insights at the intersection of feminist thought and AI studies
- Employ innovative methodological approaches to studying Feminist AI
- Examine understudied contexts, especially in the Global South
- Propose concrete interventions to address gender biases in AI
- Highlight voices and experiences of women interacting with or impacted by AI technologies in the workplace
- Take an intersectional approach, considering how AI impacts individuals with multiple marginalized identities
- Critically examine the role of AI in shaping inclusion and exclusion in digital work environments

Submission and Review Process

To be considered for this special issue, submissions must fit with the aim and scope of Gender, Work and Organizations (https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/journal/14680432)

All manuscripts must be uploaded via the journal's online submission system (https://submission.wiley.com/journal/gwao) between September 1 and November 1 2025. Please refer to the Author Guidelines (https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/page/journal/14680432/homepage/forauthors.html) before submission. Please select the 'Original Article' as the article type on submission. On the Additional Information page during submission, select 'Yes, this is for a Special Issue' and the Special Issue title from the dropdown list, 'Feminist AI: Feminist perspectives on Artificial Intelligence (AI) in the workplace'. For questions about the submission system please contact the Editorial Office at gwooffice@wiley.com.

All submissions will be double-blind peer-reviewed by multiple reviewers. Interested scholars are welcome to contact any of the guest editors to discuss their paper ideas to receive developmental feedback: Alessandra Lazazzara (alessandra.lazazzara@unimi.it), Efpraxia D. Zamani (efpraxia.zamani@durham.ac.uk), Andri Georgiadou (andri.georgiadou@nottingham.ac.uk), Ayushi Tandon (ayushitandon@iima.ac.in).

Preparing your Submission

The guest editors will organize two virtual pre-submission workshops.

A first virtual pre-submission workshop is planned to take place in May 2025, where the guest editors will present the SI and authors can share their ideas and receive constructive feedback. Interested scholars might submit an abstract of 500 words to Alessandra Lazazzara (alessandra.lazazzara@unimi.it) by April 30th, 2025. The workshop will be hosted by the UK Academy of Information Systems and co-organised with the AIS Women's Network College (joining details will be forwarded post abstract submission).

A second virtual pre-submission workshop will take place in September 2025. It will be a British Academy of Management GIM SIG webinar. This interactive session will serve as a platform for discussing the special issue's objectives and aims whilst exploring contemporary research on AI in the workplace. The webinar offers participants the unique chance to gain insights from the editors' expertise and learn about recent developments in workplace AI research. Interested scholars could send a proposal of up to five pages or about 3,000 words to Alessandra Lazazzara (alessandra.lazazzara@unimi.it) by August 31st, 2025.

Further details about the pre-submission workshops will be announced in due course. Attending the workshops will not have a bearing on the editorial process and is not a prerequisite for publication in the special issue.

Moreover, the Gender, Work and Organization Conference (Nantes, July 20th-23rd - https://event.fourwaves.com/gwo2025/pages) will host a stream dedicated to this Special Issue presenting an excellent opportunity for potential contributors to engage directly with the special issue guest editors. Attendees will have the valuable opportunity to network with fellow scholars interested in this emerging field and receive guidance on crafting submissions that align with the special issue's focus.

Special Issue timeline

May 2025: Virtual pre-submission workshop (optional participation; abstract submission required by April 30, 2025).

June-Oct 2025: Availability of guest editors at conferences (e.g., EURAM, EGOS, GWO Conference, AOM, ItAIS)

Sept 2025: Virtual pre-submission workshop - British Academy of Management GIM SIG webinar (optional participation; proposal of up to five pages or about 3,000 words required by August 31st, 2025).

Sept–Nov 2025: Submission window open from 1 September 2025 to 1 November 2025

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About the Guest Editors

Alessandra Lazazzara is an Associate Professor of Organization Theory and Human Resource Management at the University of Milan, Italy, where she serves as the Chair of the Bachelor's Degree Program in Management of Organizations and Work. Her research interests include AI and HRM, workplace inclusion, and job crafting. Her research has been published in several international journals, including Journal of Vocational Behavior, The International Journal of Human Resource Management, Personnel Review; and International Journal of Electronic Commerce, among others. She is an Associate Editor of Gender, Work and Organization and serves as Vice President of ItAIS (the Italian Chapter of the Association for Information Systems). Alessandra has recently published a book on AI and HRM Processes (Franco Angeli, 2025).

Efpraxia D. Zamani is an Associate Professor of Information Systems at Durham University Business School, UK. Her research interests are found at the intersection of organizational and social implications of Information Systems and emerging technologies. Her work has appeared in the Information Systems Journal, the Journal of Information Technology, Government Information Quarterly, and Technological Forecasting and Social Change, among others. She is currently serving as the Vice President of the UK Academy of Information Systems and as co-chair of the AIS Women's Network College. In 2024 she received the AIS Sandra Slaughter Service Award.

Dr. Andri Georgiadou is an Associate Professor in the Nottingham University Business School. She is the School's Director of Equality, Diversity and Inclusion and the External Engagement Director for OB/HRM. Her work revolves around two main themes: fostering inclusion and diversity in the workplace, and exploring how AI and algorithmic solutions can contribute to more inclusive and sustainable work environment. Dr Georgiadou is an Associate Editor of Gender Work & Organization and the Chair of the Diversity and Equality EuroMed Academy Research Interest Group. Her research has been published in leading peer-reviewed journals, including the Journal of Organizational Behavior, Human Resource Management, Human Resource Management Journal, Gender Work & Organization, Journal of International Management, and European Management Review, among others. She has also contributed to numerous book chapters. She actively collaborates with a wide range of organisations, providing support to achieve sustainable results in enhancing inclusion within the hybrid workplace. Additionally, she is the founder of the Equality Inclusion Diversity Centre (EQUIDY), a non-governmental organisation dedicated to advancing inclusion and diversity.

Ayushi Tandon is Assistant Professor at Trinity Business School, Trinity College Dublin, Ireland. Her research interests include user engagement with digital platforms and the economic and societal implications of digital technology usage. She has published experiment-based research leveraging mobile applications, as well as qualitative research on accessibility in virtual technology and the digitalization of women's health records in India. Her recent work has appeared in *Information Systems Research* and the *Journal of Workplace Learning*. Ayushi was listed among 100 Brilliant Women in AI Ethics, 2022. Prior to her PhD in management she has worked as engineer at Qualcomm India on product lines such as Snapdragon.